As a great sign of Akbar's trust, young Prince Murad and a few other boys from the nobility were entrusted to the Jesuits for an education. Murad was taught to make the sign of the cross and to call upon the name of Jesus and Mary at the beginning of lessons. The young boy, ten years old at the time, 'was an ideal pupil as regards natural ability, good conduct and intellectual capacity. In all these respects,' added Monserrate, 'it would have been hard to find any Christian youth, let alone a prince, surpassing him.' The Jesuits were also delighted by what appeared to be sincere reverence from both the Hindus and the Muslims in Fatehpur Sikri towards their religious icons. They owned a statue of the Virgin Mary whose fame quickly spread through the town and throngs of Muslims and Hindus 'lifted their hands to heaven and did reverence before it'. The Jesuits were moved to note that at least in the field of idol worship, the Muslims and Hindus were superior to the Protestants of Europe.

The Jesuits at the Mughal court were deadly serious about the mission they were on. They were in Hindustan for the sole purpose of converting 'heathens' and 'moors'. The early Jesuits were limited by their ignorance of Hindu and Muslim beliefs, preventing them from going beyond what they believed was vile superstition. They repeatedly used horrified terms for the Hindus, referring to their 'false gods', their 'sect of perdition' and accused the Prophet Muhammad of the most debased behaviour. From as early as 1550 a great temple in Cochin had been destroyed by the Christians and in Divar, north of Goa, where many pilgrims came to bathe in a holy river, the place was desecrated at least once by the Portuguese in 1557 by cutting up a cow and throwing the pieces into the river. In 1567, Antony de Noronha, the Viceroy of Goa, ordered the destruction of all temples and idols in Salsette and one Father Lewis Goes went to tear down a Hindu statue of 'Manmay', the Salsette Venus, 'the centre of a voluptuous and degrading worship', with his own hands. Jesuit priests and their converts had ruthlessly destroyed temples, even while admitting they were 'highly honoured by the Hindus who treated them as living beings'. Monserrate would also be appreciative of the efforts of the Muslims to rid the Hindu population of idolatry. On their way to Fatehpur Sikri, Monserrate had written with satisfaction of the numerous destroyed 'idol temples' which littered the countryside. Many of these temples had been destroyed by earlier Muslim rulers, however, and Monserrate added with dismay that because of 'the carelessness of these same Musulmans' sacrifices have been allowed 'to be publicly performed,